Ideation Phase — Empathize & Discover

Empathy Map Canvas

Date	2 October 2026
Team ID	————————————
Project Name	Car Rental Request Automation in ServiceNow Using Service Catalog and Workflows
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Empathy Map Canvas

An empathy map is a one-page visual that gathers what we know about a user: what they say, think, do and feel. Building it helps a team look at a problem through the user's eyes and stay focused on their goals and frustrations rather than on assumptions.

Before designing any solution, the team needs to understand who is facing the problem and what it is really like for them. This canvas records that understanding for the car rental request process.

Empathy Map: Car Rental Request Automation

Primary user: An employee who needs a rental car for an official trip. Secondary users: the reporting manager who approves the request and the fleet administrator who allocates the vehicle.

SAYS

- *"I'm travelling Tuesday to Friday — who handles car bookings?"*
- *"Did my manager approve this yet?"*
- *"I emailed the admin desk ten days ago and heard nothing."*
- *"Why can't I just submit a form and watch its progress?"*

THINKS

- *"Will a car actually be waiting when I arrive?"*
- *"My manager is travelling a lot; the approval may sit unseen."*
- *"I'm not sure which details the admin team needs from me."*
- *"Chasing people over email can't be the best way to do this."*

EMPLOYEE NEEDING A RENTAL CAR

Wants a quick, clear and trouble-free way to get a vehicle for work travel

DOES

- Writes emails or phones the admin desk to ask for a vehicle
- Types the same dates, places and car choice again and again
- Keeps nudging the manager and the fleet team for updates
- Books a cab or uses a personal vehicle as a fallback

FEELS

- Annoyed by slow replies and no visibility
- Worried when the trip is at short notice
- Unsure about who is responsible for what
- Calm and reassured once the booking is confirmed

PAINS	GAINS
• Requests submitted with missing or wrong details • Approval mails buried in crowded inboxes • No way to track status and no alerts • Clashing bookings and cars that are not available • Heavy manual effort for admins and approvers	• A single Service Catalog form with required fields • Approvals routed automatically, with reminders • Email updates at each important step • Quicker vehicle allocation with fewer mistakes • Reports and a full audit trail of every request

Key Insights

- Employees want a single place to ask for a car and follow its progress; a ServiceNow Service Catalog item delivers exactly that.
- Waiting on the approver causes the longest delays, so approvals and reminders should be handled automatically by Flow Designer.
- Timely notifications on submission, approval, rejection and allocation remove most of the need for follow-up calls and emails.